Cedar Valley Family Center AI use policy

Draft for board review · Effective when the board approves it · Owner: Luis, operations manager · Next review: In 12 months, or sooner once the board decides on tools

Why we have this policy. We want AI to take paperwork off your plate and help with reports. We also want to protect families, students and donors, and never send out something wrong under our name.

Who it covers. Staff, volunteers, contractors and board members.

TOOLS WE USE

- **Microsoft Copilot:** Pilot for the development team and Luis (8 licenses). May hold donor names and gift amounts. No case file or student information.
- **ChatGPT:** Work email only. Nothing about a real person.
- **New tools, add-ons and AI features.** Luis approves any new tool, plugin, AI agent or AI feature in software we own, after checking where data goes and whether the vendor trains on it. Client data also needs Grace, our privacy officer.
- **Accounts.** Use your work email, and turn off any setting that lets the vendor train on what you type.

WHAT YOU CAN USE AI FOR

- **Everyone, now.** Anyone may use ChatGPT or Copilot for work with nothing about a real person in it. Teachers may also make lesson materials and translate handouts, with no student names or scores.
- Reword an email, brainstorm, or have a form explained.
- Teachers: lesson plans, reading passages, GED practice questions, Spanish handout translations.
- Development team and Luis, in Copilot: draft appeals and thank-you letters, summarize grant guidelines.

NEEDS APPROVAL FIRST

- Any tool with a family's name or client information — *Luis and Grace, our privacy officer*
- Any tool with student names, scores, grades or attendance — *Luis and Grace, our privacy officer*
- County contract or grant reports with AI-drafted text — *Not set yet; see open questions*

OFF LIMITS

- **Never put this into an AI tool** unless the tool is approved for it above: Case files: family names, addresses, income, immigration status, children's names, domestic violence history, mental health and substance use notes (county contract). Student names, scores, grades, attendance (district agreement). Donor giving history and gift notes, except donor names and gift amounts in the Copilot pilot. Staff HR files. Passwords and logins.
- Browser plugins or extensions that read your email.
- AI-generated photos presented as real families we serve.
- AI-written public statements about news events. A person writes them.

CHECK EVERYTHING BEFORE IT GOES OUT

- A person reads everything AI helps write. Check facts, names, numbers, tone and bias, especially every number in county and grant reports. Whoever sends it is responsible.

DECISIONS ABOUT PEOPLE

- AI never decides emergency assistance funds or class placement, and never scores intake essays. Caseworkers and teachers decide.

BEING OPEN ABOUT AI

- A person signs every donor letter. We label AI-made class materials, and tell funders honestly when AI helped with grant writing.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Tell Luis and Grace the same day, even if unsure. Grace decides if client data is a breach under the county contract. No one is punished for reporting.

WHO OWNS THIS POLICY

- Luis owns this policy, keeps it current, and runs a one-hour training for everyone. The board approves the policy and changes.

OPEN QUESTIONS FOR THE BOARD

- Should we buy ChatGPT Team, extend Copilot to everyone, or neither?
- Is Canva's AI image tool approved, and for what?
- Can AI help with case notes, and what does the county allow?
- Who should approve AI-drafted text in county contract and grant reports?

Sample policy for an invented organization, drafted by Fulton Ring from a mock 30-minute call. Not legal advice; not reviewed by a real nonprofit.